

Market Survey

SMT EQUIPMENT: The Indian Market Outlook



Sudeshna Das
is director at
ComConnect

In this era of digital disruption, electronic circuits and devices are vital catalysts for various applications in sectors ranging from consumer appliances to automotive to defence. According to the changing application requirement, electronic devices and printed circuit boards (PCBs) need to be developed in various shapes, forms and sizes. And, the entire processing life-cycle of an electronic device travels through the surface-mount technology (SMT) equipment from being a PCB to a finished electronic device.

Technological advancements, combined with today's high-speed production, complete process automation and stringent quality assurance standards, are driving forward adoption of SMT manufacturing equipment. This study analyses growth opportunities and current trends in the Indian SMT equipment market, including placement, inspection and soldering equipment, screen printers, as well as rework and repair equipment.

Market opportunity

As PCBs and electronic components become more miniaturised than before, manufacturers face the challenge of placing accurate deposits of small components on miniaturised boards. This, in turn, is fuelling the demand for advanced SMT equipment with a high degree of reliability and accuracy.

According to a research report published by Markets and Markets, the global SMT market

Methodology

Information on the surface-mount technology equipment market was assimilated from various sources through secondary research. The findings were then analysed and verified through primary research by conducting extensive interviews with key industry experts. These senior professionals shared their insights on the following topics:

1. Market size
2. Market opportunities
3. Approximate growth rate
4. Market drivers
5. Market trends
6. Types of equipment in demand
7. Market challenges

A trend analysis was done on the basis of their inputs.

will reach a turnover of \$5.42 billion by 2022, growing annually at a rate of 8.9 per cent between 2017 and 2022. The market's growth will be primarily driven by higher demand for miniaturised consumer electronics products and electric vehicles with advanced features for connectivity, entertainment and safety.

The Indian SMT manufacturing equipment market will also grow along with the electronics manufacturing sector in the country. The Indian electronics market is anticipated to reach \$400 billion in 2022, with domestic manufacturing climbing to over \$100 billion. This burgeoning market presents an attractive opportunity to SMT manufacturing equipment suppliers.

According to industry experts, since India still doesn't have a mature electronics manufacturing services (EMS) industry, the best size estimate of the domestic SMT equipment industry would be 75-80 per cent of the electronics manufacturing industry.

Asia Pacific typically dominates the global SMT equipment market. For instance, it contributed 42 per cent to the overall worldwide market in 2016. For India, industry experts expect the 'Make in India' campaign, key policy initiatives by the government, deep-

Fig. 1: SMT equipment market segmentation

